

|                |    |                        |
|----------------|----|------------------------|
| involving A    | -- | <b>356<sup>1</sup></b> |
| involving B    | -- | <b>378</b>             |
| involving C    | -- | <b>285</b>             |
| involving 048  | -- | <b>62</b>              |
| involving 0232 | -- | <b>4</b>               |

Each of these twelve uncials is plainly independent of all the others.<sup>2</sup> The total lack of pattern in the attestation that these early uncials give to **f<sup>35</sup>** shows just as plainly that **f<sup>35</sup>** is independent of them all as well, quite apart from the 22.1% without them. But that 77.9% of the units receive early uncial support, without pattern or dependency, shows that the **f<sup>35</sup> text** is early.

I invite special attention to the first block, where a single uncial sides with **f<sup>35</sup>**; each of the seven uncials is independent of the rest (and of **f<sup>35</sup>**) at this point, of necessity, yet together they attest 15% of the total (119 ÷ 795). Since there is no pattern or dependency for this 15%, how shall we account for these 119 early readings in **f<sup>35</sup>**? Will anyone argue that whoever ‘concocted’ the first **f<sup>35</sup>** MS had all these uncials in front of him, arbitrarily taking 9 readings from P<sup>72</sup>, 2 from P<sup>100</sup>, 40 from **ℵ**, etc., etc., etc.? Really now, how shall we account for these 119 early readings in **f<sup>35</sup>**? (Should anyone demur that the 5<sup>th</sup> century MSS included really are not all that early, I inquire: are they copies, or original creations? If they are copies their exemplars were obviously earlier—all of these 119 readings doubtless existed in the 3<sup>rd</sup> century.)

Going on to the next block, we have another 148 readings where there is no pattern or dependency; 119 + 148 = 267 = 34%. Really now, how shall we account for these 267 early readings in **f<sup>35</sup>**? Going on to the next

<sup>1</sup> This number is correct; it just happens to be the same.

<sup>2</sup> As further evidence of their independence, I list the singular readings for each of these uncials (five have none):

|                 | <u>James</u> | <u>1Peter</u> | <u>2Peter</u> | <u>1John</u> | <u>2&amp;3John</u> | <u>Jude</u> | <u>TOTAL</u> |
|-----------------|--------------|---------------|---------------|--------------|--------------------|-------------|--------------|
| P <sup>72</sup> |              | 33            | 12            |              |                    | 17          | <b>62</b>    |
| P <sup>78</sup> |              |               |               |              |                    | 2           | <b>2</b>     |
| <b>ℵ</b>        | 11           | 25            | 13            | 18           | 5                  | 4           | <b>76</b>    |
| <b>A</b>        | 8            |               | 5             | 10           | 2                  | 2           | <b>27</b>    |
| <b>B</b>        | 7            | 10            | 3             | 8            | 4                  | 5           | <b>37</b>    |
| <b>C</b>        | 3            | 7             | 7             | 5            | 2                  |             | <b>24</b>    |
| <b>048</b>      | 1            |               | 1             | 4            | 3                  |             | <b>9</b>     |